

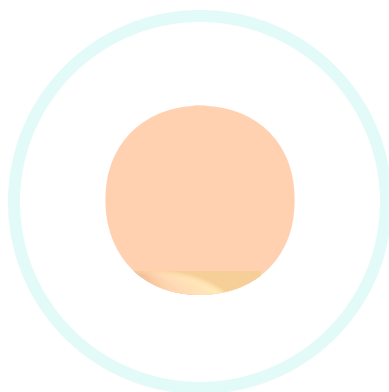


The Khan Family & Cookbook

recipes, memories & a little chaos

in the kitchen, together

A collection by **Noor & Yahya Khan**



Breads & Bakes

Warm from the tawa or the oven.

IN THIS SECTION

Breads & Bakes

Where precision pays off — scales, timers, and a thermometer that actually gets used.

Munshi Naan

Yahya

Everyday Loaf

Yahya

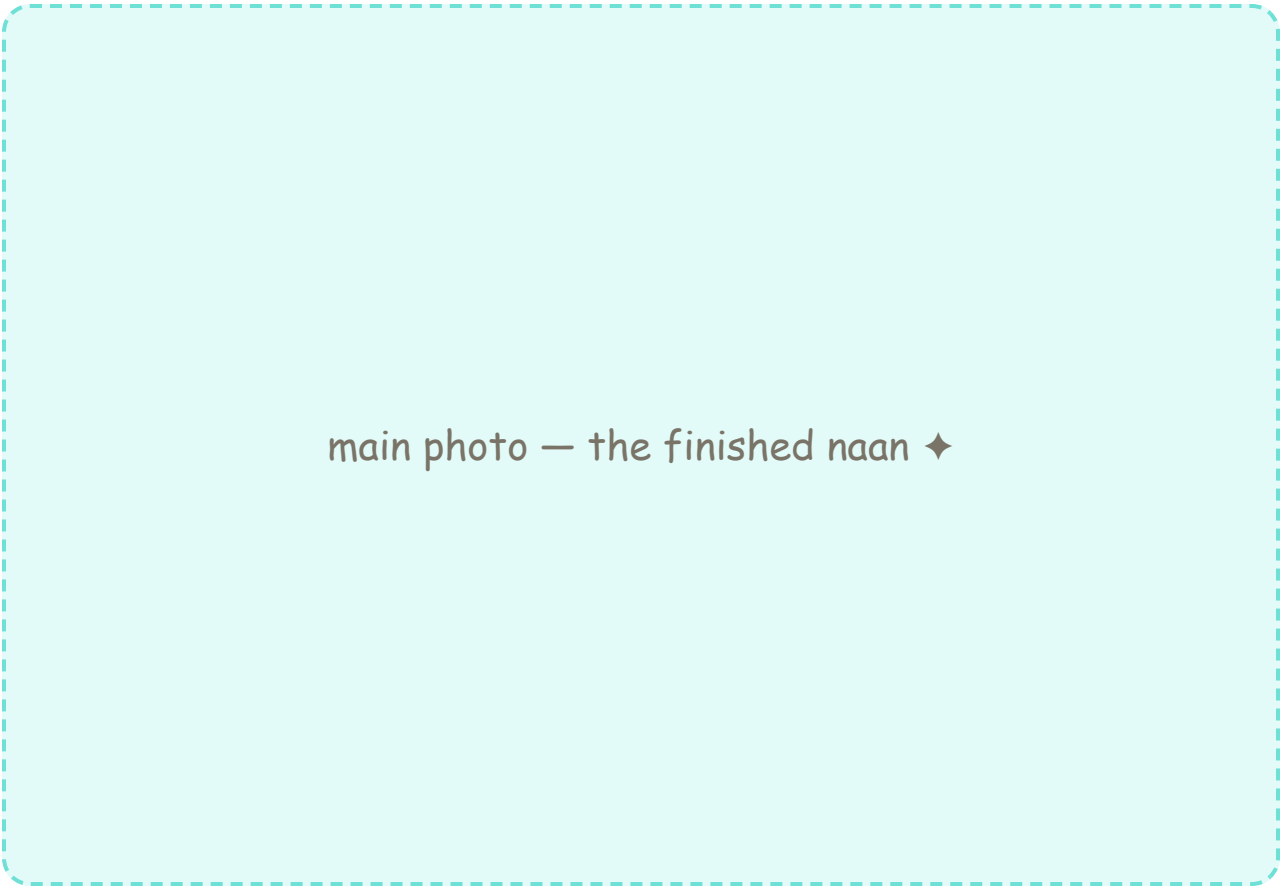
BREADS & BAKES · YEASTED

Munshi *Naan*

***Soft, pillowy, and weighed to the gram.** The yogurt is what keeps the crumb tender instead of bready, and the ghee off the heat gives it that glossy, restaurant-style finish. Measured, not guessed — so it comes out the same every time.*

from the kitchen of Yahya

MUNSHI NAAN



main photo — the finished naan ♦

fresh off the tava



side photo ♦

the risen dough



side photo ♦

rolled and ready

Munshi Naan

from the kitchen of Yahya

MAKES 4 • RISE 60–90 MIN • COOK 2–3 MIN EACH

INGREDIENTS

All-Purpose Flour	240 g	Warm Milk (or water)	120 g
Active Dry Yeast (Khamir)	3 g	Salt	4.5 g
Sugar	4 g	Plain Yogurt	30 g
Ghee (or melted butter)	14 g		

Milk warm, not hot — ~105°F (40°C). Above 115°F (46°C) kills the yeast.

METHOD

- 1 Bloom the yeast.** Stir the yeast and sugar into the warm milk (120 g, ~105°F). Stand 5–10 min until foamy.
- 2 Mix.** Combine flour (240 g) and salt (4.5 g). Add the yogurt (30 g), ghee (14 g) and yeast milk. Mix to a shaggy dough.
- 3 Knead.** 8–10 min by hand until smooth, soft and slightly tacky — it should spring back when pressed.
- 4 First rise.** Cover and rest in a warm spot 60–90 min, until doubled.
- 5 Divide & shape.** Knock back, divide into 4 (~102 g each). Ball, cover, rest 10 min.
- 6 Roll.** Roll each into a teardrop ~8 in long, ~1/4 in thick.
- 7 Cook hot.** Screaming-hot tava, 2–3 min total — flip once big bubbles form and it's charred in spots.
- 8 Finish.** Brush with ghee off the heat; keep wrapped in a towel so they stay soft.

Yahya's note: weigh everything. The yogurt is not optional — it's what makes the crumb tender. If the dough fights the roll, rest it another 5 min.

MORE FROM THIS BAKE

side photo ✦

blooming the yeast

side photo ✦

kneaded smooth

side photo ✦

bubbling on the tava

side photo ✦

brushed with ghee

BREADS & BAKES · 64% HYDRATION

Everyday *Loaf*

***The dough that does everything.** Built on a baker's formula at 64% hydration — soft enough for sandwiches, sturdy enough to shape free-form. The percentages are by weight of flour, so scale it up or down and it stays true.*

from the kitchen of Yahya

EVERYDAY LOAF



main photo — the finished loaf ♦

deep golden, cooled on a rack



side photo ♦

dough doubled



side photo ♦

the crumb

Everyday *Loaf*

from the kitchen of Yahya

1 LOAF • RISE 2 HRS • BAKE 30–35 MIN • 375°F (190°C)

FORMULA • 1 LOAF

Flour (AP or bread)	375 g • 100%	Sugar (or Honey)	12 g • 3.2%
Water (warm)	240 g • 64%	Salt	9 g • 2.4%
Butter or Oil	14 g • 3.7%	Active Dry Yeast	7 g • 1.9%
Total Dough		657 g • 175.2%	

Hydration = water ÷ flour × 100 = 64%. Aim for a final dough temp of 76–78°F (24–26°C).

METHOD

- 1 Bloom the yeast.** Stir yeast (7 g) and sugar (12 g) into warm water (240 g). Rest 5–10 min until foamy.
- 2 Mix.** Combine flour (375 g) and salt (9 g). Add the yeast water and butter or oil (14 g). Mix to a rough dough.
- 3 Knead.** 10 min by hand until smooth and elastic — it should pass a windowpane test.
- 4 Bulk rise.** Cover and ferment ~1 hr at warm room temperature, until doubled.
- 5 Shape.** Degas, shape into a tight loaf, seam-side down in a greased 9×5 in pan.
- 6 Proof.** Cover and proof 45–60 min, until it crowns ~1 in above the rim.
- 7 Bake.** 375°F (190°C) for 30–35 min, until deep golden and 200–205°F (93–96°C) inside.
- 8 Cool.** Turn out and cool on a rack at least 1 hr before slicing.

Yahya's note: the loaf is done when the thermometer says so, not when the timer rings. 64% hydration is forgiving — but weigh it either way.

MORE FROM THIS BAKE

side photo ✦

shaped in the pan

side photo ✦

proofed and risen

side photo ✦

fresh from the oven

side photo ✦

the first slice



Salans

Gravies that make the rice make sense.

IN THIS SECTION

Salans

The gravies and curries — slow-built masalas that make a plate of rice make sense.

Bhendi Ghosht

Noor

SALANS · MUTTON

Bhendi *Ghosht*

***Mutton and okra in a tangy, whole-spice gravy.** The meat is pressure-cooked soft with tomatoes, tamarind and whole garam spices, then the bhendi goes in at the end so it keeps its bite. Tangy, a little rich, and made for a big plate of hot rice.*

from the kitchen of Noor

BHENDI GHOSHT

main photo — the finished curry ♦

mutton and okra in tangy gravy

side photo ♦

side photo ♦

onions & whole spices

bhendi going in

Bhendi *Ghosht*

from the kitchen of Noor

A HEARTY POT FOR THE FAMILY • PRESSURE-COOKED, THEN FINISHED

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- mutton (goat), cut into pieces
- bhendi (okra / ladies finger), trimmed
- onions, chopped
- tomatoes, chopped
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- whole spices — cloves (long) & cinnamon
- oil, a generous pour
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania)
- salt (namak), to taste
- tamarind — paste, or concentrate in water
- garam masala powder
- curry leaves • coriander leaves • green chilies

Amounts by feel. Pressure-cook time depends on the meat: ~22 min for smallish pieces, ~35 min for larger ones.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Fry the onions.** Heat oil and fry the chopped onions until golden brown.
- 2 Whole spices.** Add the cloves and cinnamon, then the ginger-garlic paste; fry until the raw smell is gone.
- 3 Tomatoes.** Add the chopped tomatoes and fry until softened and pulpy.
- 4 Brown the mutton.** Add the mutton pieces and fry a little. Add turmeric, chili powder, salt, then coriander powder.
- 5 Add tamarind & water.** Add a little water plus tamarind paste (or tamarind concentrate in water). Stir.
- 6 Pressure-cook.** Cook the meat until tender — ~22 min for small pieces, ~35 min for larger.
- 7 Add the bhendi.** Stir in the okra with a sprinkle of garam masala, curry leaves, coriander leaves and green chilies.
- 8 Finish.** Cook until the bhendi is tender (or pressure-cook 5–10 min more). Serve hot with rice.

Amma's note: add the bhendi only after the meat is cooked so it keeps its shape and doesn't go slimy. The tamarind is what makes it tangy — start small and adjust.

MORE FROM THIS DISH

side photo ♦

tomatoes frying down

side photo ♦

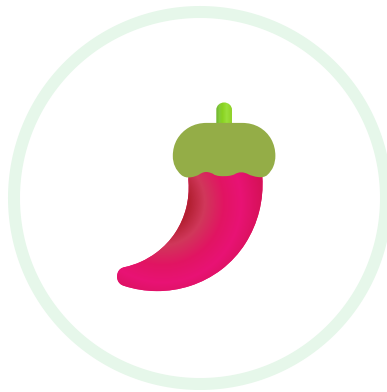
mutton browning

side photo ♦

after the pressure cook

side photo ♦

plated with rice



Chutneys

The little jars that carry the meal.

IN THIS SECTION

Chutneys

The tangy little sides — ground, tempered, and made to carry a plate of rice.

Palak Ulikaram

Noor

CHUTNEYS · ANDHRA

Palak *Ulikaram*

Spinach cooked down with a tangy, garlicky Andhra masala — roasted chilies and coriander ground with tamarind and a whole lot of garlic, then simmered into the greens until the oil comes shining back to the top. Eat it with hot white rice and a spoon of ghee, and don't count the garlic cloves.

from the kitchen of Noor

PALAK ULIKARAM



main photo — the finished dish ♦

dark, glossy, and ready for rice



side photo ♦

the ground masala



side photo ♦

spinach going in

Palak *Ulikaram*

from the kitchen of Noor

A BIG BOWL FOR THE FAMILY • A TANGY AFTERNOON DISH

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

FOR THE GROUND MASALA

- 1 big onion, roughly chopped
- a fistful of garlic cloves
- a lime-sized ball of tamarind
- a good handful of dried red chilies
- 2–3 spoons coriander seeds (dhania)
- a spoon of cumin (zira)
- salt, to taste

FOR THE TEMPERING & GREENS

- oil, a generous pour
- mustard seeds & cumin (zira)
- chana dal & urad dal, a spoon each
- a sprig of curry leaves
- a pinch of asafoetida (hing)
- red chili powder, to your bravery
- turmeric (haldi), a good pinch
- lots & lots of spinach, chopped
- coriander leaves, to finish
- ghee, for serving

Amounts are by feel — start with more garlic and chili than seems wise, then taste as you go.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Roast the whole spices.** Lightly dry-sauté the dried red chilies, coriander seeds and cumin until warm and toasty — don't burn them.
- 2 Grind.** Blend the onion, garlic, tamarind, salt and the roasted spices to a coarse paste.
- 3 Temper.** Heat oil; add mustard seeds, cumin, chana dal, urad dal and curry leaves. Let it splutter and the dals turn golden; add a pinch of hing.
- 4 Fry the paste.** Add the ground masala and fry a few minutes until it darkens and the oil separates.
- 5 Spice it.** Add chili powder, turmeric and a little more salt if needed.
- 6 Cook the spinach.** Add lots of chopped spinach. Cook and cook until the water is gone and the oil separates again.
- 7 Finish.** Stir through coriander leaves. Serve with hot rice and ghee.

Amma's note: the whole secret is patience at the end — keep cooking until the oil comes back. And add more garlic than you think.

MORE FROM THIS DISH

side photo ♦

roasting the chilies

side photo ♦

the coarse paste

side photo ♦

oil separating

side photo ♦

plated with rice



Seafood

From the coast, cooked with care.

IN THIS SECTION

Seafood

Prawns and fish, cooked quick and hot — big flavour with a squeeze and a pickle.

Jhinga Achari Fry	Noor
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Jhinga Palak	Noor
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SEAFOOD · ACHARI

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

Prawns marinated in a pickle-spiced masala, then fried till they catch at the edges. The spoonful of achar — mango, tomato, whatever's open in the fridge — is the trick: it gives the whole thing that tangy, pickly kick. Wonderful with rice and dal, or just rice and a bit of chutney.

from the kitchen of Noor

JHINGA ACHARI FRY



main photo — the finished fry ♦

crisp at the edges, curry leaves and all



side photo ♦

prawns marinating



side photo ♦

sizzling in the pan

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

from the kitchen of Noor

A PLATEFUL OF PRAWNS · QUICK FRY, BIG FLAVOUR

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

PRAWNS & MARINADE

- prawns (jhinga), heads & tails off, washed
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- salt (namak), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania) — a little extra
- cumin powder (jeera)
- kalonji (black seeds)
- cumin seeds (zira)
- a spoon of achar — mango, tomato or mixed-veg

FRYING & FINISHING

- oil, for a hot shallow fry
- a sprig of curry leaves
- chopped coriander leaves, to garnish

Any pickle works — the achar is what makes it "achari." Start with a small spoon and taste.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Prep the prawns.** Remove the heads and tails, then wash well and drain.
- 2 Marinate.** Add ginger-garlic paste, turmeric, chili powder, salt, extra coriander powder and cumin powder. Then the kalonji and cumin seeds.
- 3 The achari touch.** Stir in a spoon of achar. Mix well and let it marinate a while.
- 4 Heat the oil.** Get the oil hot and drop in the curry leaves to crackle.
- 5 Fry the prawns.** Lay them in one by one and fry, turning, until cooked through and catching at the edges.
- 6 Finish.** Garnish with coriander leaves. Serve hot with rice and dal, or rice and chutney.

Amma's note: don't crowd the pan — lay the prawns in one by one so they fry, not steam. And don't overcook; prawns are done the moment they curl and turn opaque.

MORE FROM THIS DISH

side photo ✦

cleaned prawns

side photo ✦

the achari masala

side photo ✦

curry leaves crackling

side photo ✦

plated with rice

SEAFOOD · QUICK

Jhinga *Palak*

***Shrimp and spinach, done in one quick pan.** No grinding, no fuss — just golden onions, spinach cooked down till it's wilted and dry, and jumbo shrimp slipped in at the very end so they stay plump and tender. A weeknight dish that tastes like you tried harder than you did.*

from the kitchen of Noor

JHINGA PALAK



plump shrimp in wilted greens



shrimp curled and just done

side photo ♦

straight from the pan

Jhinga *Palak*

from the kitchen of Noor

A QUICK WEEKNIGHT PAN • READY IN ABOUT 20 MINUTES

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- jumbo shrimp, tails & shells off, cleaned
- a lot of spinach (palak), chopped
- 1 onion, chopped
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- olive oil, for frying
- salt (namak), to taste
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania)

Extra-large / jumbo shrimp hold up best — they stay plump in the quick cook. Amounts by feel; taste as you go.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Fry the onions.** Heat olive oil and fry the chopped onion until lightly golden brown.
- 2 Ginger-garlic.** Add the ginger-garlic paste and fry with the onions until the raw smell is gone.
- 3 Add the palak.** Tip in lots of chopped spinach along with salt, turmeric, chili powder and coriander powder.
- 4 Cook it down.** Cook and cook until all the water from the spinach is gone and it's wilted and cooked through.
- 5 Add the shrimp.** Slip in the cleaned jumbo shrimp and cook quickly — about 2 minutes — just until they turn opaque and are done.
- 6 Serve.** That's it. Lovely with rice or roti.

Amma's note: the shrimp go in last and cook fast — two minutes, no more. Overcooked shrimp turn rubbery, so pull the pan the moment they curl and turn opaque.

MORE FROM THIS DISH



side photo ✦

cleaned jumbo shrimp



side photo ✦

palak cooking down



side photo ✦

shrimp just added



side photo ✦

plated with rice